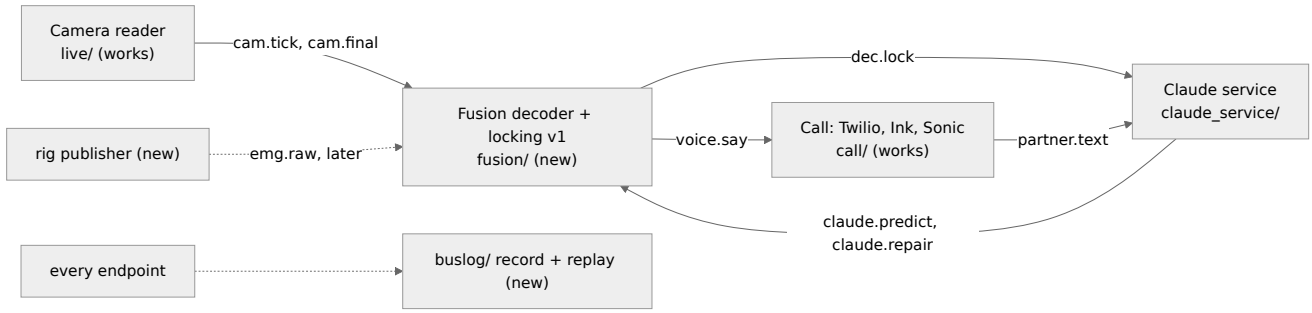
Build plan: from today's code to the demo

Written 2026-10-24, about 30 hours before we present. The spec is REALTIME_PIPELINE.md; this file says what is left, in what order, and what we drop if we run late. Every claim is tagged: **[ran]** checked by running something, **[code]** read in the code, **[assumed]** not checked. "ASK" marks what only a person can answer.

The plan on one page

The middle of the pipeline did not exist on Oct 24: nothing produced `dec.*` or `voice.say`, and nothing put `emg.raw` on the bus [ran]. Both ends work on their own: the camera reader (`live/`, 180 tests) and the call (`call/`: Twilio, Ink, Sonic, 23 tests) [ran]. So the first goal is one path through the middle, camera only:



Critical path: **bus → decoder v1 → first end-to-end call → replay of sessions 1 and 2 → lock model fit → session 3 metrics → rehearsal.** EMG joins the decoder only if a 4-channel SVR-1 checkpoint helps on replay; the demo does not wait for it.

When	Milestone	Done when
T-30h to T-24h	Shared bus (`bus/`), decoder + locking v1, logger + replay, `emg.raw` publisher, Claude service on the bus	Unit tests pass with fake publishers; a logged fake session replays
T-24h to T-18h	First live call on the laptop: camera → decoder → Claude → Sonic → Twilio	A teammate as the judge hears 5 mouthed sentences; latency in the log
T-18h to T-12h	Sleep in shifts. Replay sessions 1 and 2 through the decoder; fit lock weights and threshold	WER and mouth-to-lock on sessions 1 and 2 beat the hand-set weights
T-12h to T-8h	EMG joins, only if SVR-1 4-ch is ready and helps on replay; dashboard on real topics	WER with EMG ≤ without it on sessions 1 and 2
T-8h	**Code freeze.** Record session 3 in demo conditions, on battery	Session 3 logged; never trained on
T-8h to T-4h	Metrics on session 3; failure drills; README setup steps	The numbers table below filled in
T-4h to T-0	Rehearse the 2-minute call 3 times; charge with the Uno unplugged	3 clean runs in a row

Cut line. If behind at T-12h: drop EMG from the decoder (the fallback CLAUDE.md protects) and the dashboard's EMG traces. At T-6h: drop the learned lock model (keep the hand-set weights) and pace/effort. At T-2h: drop live Claude repairs (predictions only) and emotion. Never cut: camera → decoder → voice into the call, "Please repeat", logging.

Owners. Austin: decoder and locking sign-off, lock model fit, SVR-1, session 3. Evan: camera reader on the laptop, `laptop_check.sh` on battery. Frank: call, voice clone, dashboard on real topics. Thai: rig publisher, Claude service, prompt tuning on replayed logs. Agents write code against the contract below; one integrator (Austin) merges.

Where the code stands (Oct 24)

Part	Status	Evidence
Rig reader, `rig/filters.py`	works on the rig, untested here	`rig/reader.py`, `rig/filters.py:15` [code]
`emg.raw` on the bus	being built: `rig/publish.py`	no ZeroMQ in `rig/` before [ran]
SVR-1 preprocessing	**violates CLAUDE.md**: `svr/preprocess.py:40,46` use `filtfilt`, called from `svr/finetune.py:45`	[code]
SVR-1 on 4 channels	no checkpoint here; Gaddy-arch on 4 ch: WER 89 to 95, homophene-10 28 to 36 % (8 ch: 88 %)	`benchmark_results/LEADERBOARD.md` [ran]
`svr/infer.py`	missing; the API is drafted on the team board	[ran]
Camera reader	works on CPU tests; laptop numbers missing	`tests/live` 180 passed [ran]; branch `feat/camera-live`, unmerged
Final pass (beam + LM)	about 1.1 s for a 7.7 s clip on the 5090, even at beam 3	`live/MEASURED.md` [ran]
Fusion decoder, locking	being built: `fusion/`	nothing produced `dec.*` [ran]
Claude service	draft; moving to the shared bus	`claude_service/` [code]
Call: Twilio, Ink, Sonic	works with fakes; outside git	`tests/call` 23 passed [ran]
Dashboard	prototype on sample data; outside git	`demo/dashboard/README.md` [code]
Logger, replay	being built: `buslog/`	none before [ran]
Recorder	merged to main with the delivery styles (#10)	`git log origin/main` [ran]

Code that must move into the repo (CLAUDE.md: all code lives in this repo): `live/` (already on `feat/camera-live`), `call/`, `tests/call/`, `tests/live/`, `demo/dashboard/`, `scripts/setup_envs.sh`.

The hard problems, decided

Each quotes the spec where it decides, and proposes where it is silent. Proposals need the owner's sign-off.

1. **Joint search over two models with different units.** The spec: camera and EMG grade every draft as it grows (REALTIME_PIPELINE.md, "The fusion decoder"). Proposal (Austin): v1 decodes camera greedy CTC into words and scores each word, not each piece. EMG joins at the word level: for each word span (camera frame times → EMG frames on the shared clock), SVR-1 scores the word and its look-alikes with its letter CTC over that span. This avoids aligning SentencePiece at 25 fps with letters at 86 fps inside one beam. Risk: a word the camera never proposed can only enter as a look-alike or a Claude prediction.
2. **Stable words across passes.** The spec is silent. v1: align each pass's words to the previous pass (difflib) and count unchanged passes; locked words are a pinned prefix that later passes cannot rewrite.
3. **Word finished, sentence ended.** The spec: the decoder moved on, the lips pause or the muscles go quiet; a sentence ends after about 0.5 s still. The camera reader already ends a segment after 0.5 s without mouthing and caps at 8 s with a 2 s overlap (`live/bus_schema.md`), so v1 uses segment end, and EMG quiet later.
4. **Lock model data.** The spec: every word on every pass is an example. Replaying a session through the decoder regenerates every pass's ingredients, so the logger only needs the inputs (`cam.*`, `emg.raw`, `partner.text`) and the prompt shown. The recorder stores each clip's video with per-frame `time.monotonic()` stamps (`recorder/README.md`), and the camera reader already replays a recorded clip on its own clock (`live/run.py --replay`, `live/source.py:resolve_recording`) [code]. So a session becomes training data by running the camera reader over each clip into the logger, then replaying that log through the decoder and scoring `dec.lock` against the manifest's prompt (`fusion/evaluate.py`).
5. **Claude timing.** The spec: 0.3 s repair window; later repairs fix captions only. Claude Opus at low effort may take longer than 0.3 s; measure p50/p95 on the first live call. If p95 > 0.3 s, repairs become captions-only fixes and the window stays 0.3 s (voice speed comes first).
6. **GPU and battery.** Every number in the "Delays" table is an estimate until measured on the RTX 5060 on battery. Evan runs `live/bench/laptop_check.sh` and `python -m live.bench.tick_bench` on battery first thing.
7. **One clock.** Everything is `time.monotonic()` on the laptop: camera `frame_t`, EMG `t0` per batch, and the logger's receive time. Drift check: the replay compares `t_pub` with receive time.
8. **Phone, emotion, limits.** Twilio and Sonic both use μ-law 8 kHz, so there is no conversion (`call/README.md`). Frank found that Sonic ignores `generation_config` changes inside a context but honours inline `<speed>/<volume>/<emotion>` tags; Cartesia's build rule asks for `generation_config`, so use it per sentence and the tags only per word. ASK Frank: does the face's label set match Cartesia's emotions? Claude spend over rehearsals: ASK Thai to check the rate limit tier.

Interface contract (frozen for the agents)

- One bus module, `bus/`: ZeroMQ PUB/SUB, msgpack, numpy as `{'nd': 1, dtype, shape, data}`, plus `v`, `seq`, `t_pub`, the same wire format as the camera reader.
- One endpoint per producer, each overridable by `RECLAIM_<NAME>_PUB`: `emg` (`emg.raw`), `cam` (`cam.tick`, `cam.final`, `cam.face`), `dec` (`dec.hyp`, `dec.lock`, `dec.repeat`, `voice.say`), `claude` (`claude.predict`, `claude.repair`, `timing.claude`), `call` (`partner.text`, `timing.call`), all under `ipc:///tmp/reclaim/`.
- Fields as in the Interfaces table of TEAM_TASKS_AND_INTERFACES.md, plus `cam.face` (`live/bus_schema.md`). `voice.say` `pace` and `effort` are relative to normal: 1.0 is Austin's usual rate and effort, until SVR-1 provides them.
- Tests use `inproc://` or a temporary folder, never the real endpoints.

Numbers to show (Anthropic track)

Metric	From
WER on session 3: camera, camera + EMG, camera + EMG + Claude	replay of session 3 with each reader on or off, vs the prompts
Mouth-to-lock, mouth-to-audio	`cam.tick` frame times → `dec.lock` → `voice.say` → `timing.call`
Please-repeat rate	`dec.repeat` per sentence
First-try understanding	rehearsal calls: did the judge answer without asking again (by hand)

Failure drills (before rehearsal)

Pull the Uno: captions go on from the camera. Cover the mouth: "Please repeat", no guess. Turn off Wi-Fi to Claude: the voice keeps flowing, no repairs. Kill the Sonic stream: the call service reconnects or speaks whole sentences.

Sponsor checks

- Anthropic: show raw and fixed text side by side; the 4 metrics above; quote a laryngectomee or speech therapist (ASK: who has talked to one?); mention Claude Code built it.
- Cartesia: Sonic 3.6, Instant Voice Clone with consent, Ink for the judge, `generation_config`, no Line SDK; README setup steps (missing); no keys committed.

Pre-demo checklist

Battery full, charger unplugged with the Uno connected; signal check on all 4 channels; 1-minute calibration; `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`, Cartesia and Twilio keys in the environment; Twilio number and tunnel up; logger running.